

Since we have a fair idea of the role of the boot loader let's look at the two boot loaders available for Linux systems.

9.1.1 LILO

Linux Loader is the traditional boot loader and it is perhaps still used in servers that run Linux as their Operating system. Grub or the GGrand Unified Boot loader replaced it as the 'cool' and secure alternative.

LILO has a configuration script—`lilo.conf`—located under the `/boot` partition. This is the file that LILO reads during the booting of a system.

The file `lilo.conf` may look similar to the one below.

```
boot=/dev/hda
map=/boot/map
install=/boot/boot.b
prompt
timeout=10
message=/boot/message
lba32
default=LINUX-MINE

image=/boot/vmlinuz-2.4.0-0.43.6
label=LINUX-MINE
initrd=/boot/initrd-2.4.0-0.43.6.img
read-only
root=/dev/hda5

other=/dev/hda1
label=Windows XP
```

Among the few things that you can change here are:

'timeout=' This is the maximum time in seconds to choose an OS to boot; else it will boot default

'default=' Type the label on the OS you want to boot as default on timeout.

And **'label='** You can type just about anything here. Put